

Current Office, Email and Statement Evaluation — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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61.1 Word: structured content and content controls

Most Word documents are free-form, but many office documents — forms, templates, and records — need *structure*: a fixed place for a name, a date, a choice from a list, or a check box. Word provides **content controls** for exactly this task. A content control is an individual element that you insert at a chosen point in a document or template; the user can type or choose only what the control allows.

Definition (Content control). *A single, structured element inserted into a Word document or template to capture one piece of information in a controlled way.*

Common content controls include plain text, rich text, picture, drop-down list, combo box, date picker, and check box. They are inserted from the **Developer** tab, which is hidden by default and is enabled through Word Options → Customize Ribbon. A content control can restrict editing at that spot and can enforce limited **data validation**: a drop-down list allows only the listed items, and a date picker allows only a date. This is the fact behind the JA 2026 word item (PYQ-12): a content control *can* enforce data validation, so the statement that it cannot is the incorrect one.

Content controls should not be confused with *placeholders*, which belong to PowerPoint slide layouts, or with form *fields* from older Word versions. In this course, “content control” means the Word Developer-tab element that structures a document.

61.2 First-line and hanging indents

Indentation decides how far a paragraph’s text sits from the left (or right) margin. Word distinguishes two special paragraph indents.

Indent	Meaning
First-line indent	Only the first line of the paragraph is indented; the remaining lines start at the left margin.
Hanging indent	Every line except the first is indented; the first line hangs out to the left. Used for references, bibliographies, and bulleted lists.

Definition (Hanging indent). *A paragraph indent in which all lines except the first are pushed inward, so the first line “hangs” at the left margin.*

These are paragraph-level formatting settings. Two paragraphs can carry different indents even when they use the *same style*, because a paragraph style supplies a default that individual

paragraphs can override. The usual wrong statement claims that a hanging indent shifts the first line; in fact the first line is the one that stays out, and all the others move inward.

61.3 The Navigation Pane

The **Navigation Pane** is a Word panel opened from the **View** tab. It is a browsing aid rather than a formatting tool. It presents three views or tabs.

1. **Headings**: an outline of the document built from paragraphs that carry a *Heading style* (Heading 1, Heading 2, and so on).
2. **Pages**: thumbnail pictures of each page.
3. **Results**: the matches for text typed into the search box.

Because the Headings view is driven by heading styles, applying a Heading style does two things at once: it gives the paragraph an outline level and it makes the paragraph appear in the Navigation Pane (and in an automatic Table of Contents).

Example 61.3.1. *A student writes a long report. Applying Heading 1 to each chapter title makes every chapter appear in the Navigation Pane, so the reader can jump straight to any chapter. A reviewer's comment on a sentence does not appear in the Navigation Pane; comments are read in the markup/comments pane. That distinction is the trap in JA 2026 (PYQ-12).*

61.4 Track Changes and revision metadata

Track Changes is Word's review tool. When it is switched on, every edit is recorded as a *revision* instead of being applied silently. Three kinds of change are tracked: insertions, deletions, and formatting changes. Each recorded change stores **metadata** — the **author's name** and the **date and time** of the edit.

Definition (Revision metadata with Track Changes). *The information Word stores alongside a tracked change: who made it and when.*

A tracked change can be **accepted** or **rejected**. Accepting a change keeps the new text as final and **removes the revision metadata** attached to that change; rejecting a change restores the original text. Before sharing a document, Word's *Inspect Document* feature can be used to strip hidden personal information such as author names.

61.5 Section Break versus Page Break

Word documents are divided into **sections**, and page-level settings belong to a section. The two breaks behave quite differently.

Break	What it does	What it changes
Page Break	Moves the following text to the next page.	Nothing else; the document stays in the same section with the same headers, footers, and margins.
Section Break	Starts a new section .	Each section may have its own headers and footers, margins, page orientation, columns, and page numbering.

Definition (Section Break). *A break that ends the current section and begins a new one, so that page-level formatting can differ from that point onward.*

Example 61.5.1. *A report needs no header on the title page but a running header on every later page. Inserting a single Page Break will not do it, because both pages remain in one section. The correct tool is a **Section Break** after the title page, after which the new section can carry its own header. This is the exact distinction tested in JA 2026 (PYQ-13): Section Break, not Page Break, allows different headers and footers in one document.*

61.6 Excel: nested IF, blank and non-numeric input

An **IF** function chooses between two values: `=IF(condition, value_if_true, value_if_false)`. A **nested IF** places a second IF inside one of those two positions, which lets one formula test several conditions in turn:

`=IF(A1>50,"High",IF(A1>25,"Medium","Low"))`.

Excel evaluates the conditions from left to right and returns the value of the **first** condition that is TRUE; once a condition is satisfied, the remaining tests are skipped.

Example 61.6.1. *With $A1 = 70$ the first condition ($70 > 50$) is TRUE, so the result is High. With $A1 = 30$ the first condition is FALSE but the second ($30 > 25$) is TRUE, so the result is Medium. With $A1 = 10$ both are FALSE, so the result is Low.*

The behaviour on **blank** and **non-numeric** input is the trap (PYQ-14). In a numeric comparison Excel treats a **blank cell as zero**. Therefore, if A1 is empty, $A1 > 50$ is FALSE and $A1 > 25$ is also FALSE, so the formula falls through to the final value — *Low*. A blank cell does not make the formula stop or produce an error; it is simply read as 0.

Non-numeric **text** is different again. Text is not a number, so:

- arithmetic on it fails — for example `=A1+5` with text in A1 returns the error `#VALUE!`;
- `ISNUMBER` returns FALSE for a text cell and for a blank cell.

For this reason, robust formulas guard the input, for instance with `ISBLANK`, `ISNUMBER`, or `IFERROR`, before using the value in a calculation.

61.7 COUNTIFS and SUMPRODUCT

Counting rows that meet *several* conditions at once is a frequent task. Excel offers two routes.

Definition (COUNTIFS). A function that counts the rows satisfying all of the given range-and-criteria pairs (AND logic): *COUNTIFS(range1, criteria1, range2, criteria2, ...)*.

The **COUNTIFS** function takes *paired* arguments: a range followed by the criterion that applies to it, repeated for each condition. All the ranges must be the same size. The singular **COUNTIF** handles one condition; the plural **COUNTIFS** handles several. Text criteria can use the wildcards * (any sequence of characters) and ? (any one character).

Definition (SUMPRODUCT). A function that multiplies corresponding elements of the given arrays and returns the sum of those products.

On its own, SUMPRODUCT(A1:A3,B1:B3) returns A1*B1 + A2*B2 + A3*B3. It can also be used to *count*, by building boolean arrays and multiplying them:

=SUMPRODUCT((A1:A10>50)*(B1:B10="Yes"))

counts the rows in which the first condition AND the second condition are both true, because the product is 1 only when both parts are 1. The double-unity form =SUMPRODUCT(--(A1:A10>50)) is a common way to coerce TRUE/FALSE into 1/0.

Example 61.7.1. To count how many students scored above 50 and belong to the Science stream, either =COUNTIFS(Marks,">50",Stream,"Science") or =SUMPRODUCT((Marks>50)*(Stream="Science")) will work. The stable distinction tested in JA 2026 (PYQ-15, TRAP-14) is that COUNTIFS takes several criteria directly, while SUMPRODUCT does arithmetic on arrays and can therefore both add and count — it does not “only add.”

61.8 Email: filters, signatures, POP3 and privacy

Filters and rules

An email **filter**, usually called a **rule** in desktop mail clients, acts automatically on messages. A rule has two parts: a **condition** (sender, recipient, subject, keywords, presence of an attachment) and an **action** (move to a folder, flag, forward, delete, mark as read). A typical rule sends all mail from one mailing list into a dedicated folder, keeping the inbox tidy.

Digital signature versus encryption

These two security features are constantly confused (PYQ-16, TRAP-15).

Point	Digital signature	Encryption
Purpose	Authenticity and integrity	Confidentiality
What it establishes	Who sent the message, and that it was not altered in transit	That only the intended reader can read the contents
Does it hide the content?	No	Yes

A **digital signature** does *not* encrypt the message body. It proves the sender’s identity and detects tampering. It is **encryption** that scrambles the content so that only the holder of the correct key can read it.

POP3 and IMAP

POP3 stands for **Post Office Protocol version 3**. It is a mail *retrieval* protocol: it **downloads** messages from the mail server to the local device. By default it typically **removes** the messages from the server, so once downloaded the mail lives only on that machine and is not kept in sync across devices. **IMAP** works differently: it leaves the mail on the server and keeps all devices synchronised. The stable distinction (PYQ-16, TRAP-17) is that POP3 downloads to the local machine, whereas IMAP syncs. **SMTP**, in contrast, is the protocol for *sending* mail.

BCC and recipient privacy

An email has three recipient fields.

Field	Full form	Visibility
To	—	Primary recipients; visible to everyone.
Cc	Carbon Copy	Copied recipients; visible to everyone.
Bcc	Blind Carbon Copy	Addresses hidden from the <i>other</i> recipients.

The key point (PYQ-16, TRAP-16) is what Bcc hides. Bcc hides the blind recipients from *each other* and from the To/Cc recipients; it does *not* hide them from the **sender**, who always sees the complete recipient list. A common wrong statement says that Bcc hides the sender and recipients from one another — the sender is never hidden.

61.9 PowerPoint SmartArt conversion

SmartArt turns a plain list into a diagram. PowerPoint can convert content in both directions, with one firm limit.

- **Text to SmartArt:** select a bulleted list and choose **Home** → Convert to SmartArt Graphic; choose a layout. The text is preserved as the diagram’s content.
- **SmartArt to text:** with the graphic selected, use SmartArt Tools Design → Convert → Convert to Text. You get a bulleted list back; the shapes and any pictures in the graphic are *lost*.
- **SmartArt to shapes:** Convert to Shapes breaks the graphic into ordinary shapes. Once that is done, the shapes **cannot** be converted back into SmartArt.

Example 61.9.1. *A presenter has six bullet points and wants a cycle diagram. She selects the list and uses Convert to SmartArt. Later she needs the plain list again, so she uses Convert to Text and the six points return as bullets. What cannot be undone is the step to individual shapes: after Convert to Shapes, rebuilding the SmartArt would mean starting over (the “re-entry” point behind PYQ-17).*

The direct source of Convert to SmartArt is *text*. A picture or a chart is not transformed into SmartArt in one step; you would instead insert a picture-type SmartArt layout and place the images by hand.

61.10 Exam retrieval and common confusions

The following distinctions prevent most errors in this unit.

1. Different headers and footers require a **Section Break**, not a Page Break (TRAP-13).
2. A **hanging indent** shifts every line except the first; a first-line indent shifts only the first line.
3. A **blank cell** is treated as 0 in a comparison; it does not cause an error (PYQ-14).
4. **COUNTIFS** counts with AND logic over paired arguments; **SUMPRODUCT** multiplies arrays and can both add and count (TRAP-14).
5. A **digital signature** gives authenticity and integrity, not confidentiality; **encryption** gives confidentiality (TRAP-15).
6. **POP3 downloads** to the local machine; **IMAP** syncs (TRAP-17).
7. **Bcc** hides recipients from each other, never from the sender (TRAP-16).
8. **Navigation Pane** shows headings, pages, and search results, not comments.

Example 61.10.1. *An item states, “A digital signature encrypts the message so that only the recipient can read it.” This is wrong. The signature establishes the sender and integrity; encryption is the feature that hides the content. The wrong option has merged two distinct security services.*

Exercises

1. Distinguish a first-line indent from a hanging indent, with one use for each.
2. State why a Section Break, and not a Page Break, is needed for different headers and footers.
3. Explain what a nested IF returns when several conditions are true at once.
4. What does =IF(A1>50,"High","Low") display when A1 is blank, and why?
5. Give the general form of COUNTIFS, and state one thing SUMPRODUCT can do that COUNTIFS cannot.
6. Distinguish a digital signature from encryption in one sentence.
7. What does POP3 do with mail, and how does that differ from IMAP?
8. In a message, who can see the addresses placed in the Bcc field?
9. Describe two directions of SmartArt conversion and one that cannot be reversed.

Solutions

1. A first-line indent indents only the first line (normal paragraph openings); a hanging indent indents every line except the first (references and bulleted lists).
2. Page-level settings such as headers and footers belong to a section. A Page Break keeps the same section, so its header/footer cannot differ; a Section Break starts a new section that can carry its own header and footer.
3. A nested IF returns the value of the *first* condition that is TRUE; once a condition is satisfied the remaining tests are skipped.
4. It displays *Low*, because a blank cell is treated as 0, and 0 is not greater than 50, so the FALSE branch is taken.
5. COUNTIFS(range1, criteria1, range2, criteria2, ...). SUMPRODUCT can multiply corresponding array elements and return their sum (arithmetic), so it can add as well as count; COUNTIFS only counts.
6. A digital signature proves the sender's identity and that the message was not altered, whereas encryption hides the content so only the intended reader can read it.
7. POP3 downloads mail from the server to the local device and by default removes it from the server; IMAP leaves mail on the server and keeps devices synchronised.
8. The sender can see all Bcc addresses, and each Bcc recipient is hidden from the other recipients (To, Cc, and the other Bcc recipients).
9. Text converts to SmartArt (Convert to SmartArt), and SmartArt converts back to text (Convert to Text). Converting SmartArt to shapes is *not* reversible — the shapes cannot be turned back into SmartArt.